

More women are gaming

- ▶ According to a 2022 study by the Entertainment Software Association (ESA), 48% of gamers in the United States are female. This number has been steadily increasing in recent years, and it is now clear that women make up a significant portion of the gaming population.
- ▶ In terms of specific genres, women are particularly active in mobile gaming. According to a 2020 study by Facebook, 61% of women globally play mobile games. This is compared to 53% of men.
- ▶ Women are also well-represented in competitive gaming. In 2021, the world's most popular esports tournament, The International, had a record number of female players. Out of the 30 teams that qualified for the tournament, 5 had at least one female player.
- ▶ In addition to their participation in competitive gaming, women are also making a name for themselves as game developers. In 2020, the International Game Developers Association (IGDA) reported that 26% of game developers were women. This number is still lower than the percentage of women who play games, but it is clear that women are increasingly involved in all aspects of the gaming industry.

Women esports winners

- ▶ 2010 WCG Ultimate Gamer Season 2 - Katherine Gunn (Mystik) won the \$100,000 prize pool for first place in the Halo Reach tournament.
- ▶ 2020 DreamHack Masters Dallas - FURIA Female won the \$100,000 prize pool for first place in the CS:GO tournament.
- ▶ 2021 ESL Impact League Season 1 - Nigma Galaxy Female won the \$100,000 prize pool for first place in the CS:GO tournament.
- ▶ 2016 DreamHack Open Valencia - Missharvey won the \$50,000 prize pool for first place in the Counter-Strike: Global Offensive tournament.

tournament in Texas. Following her high school graduation, Ortiz moved to New York City to immerse herself in the local arcade scene. She first competed at the Evolution Championship Series in 2003 and has consistently ranked highly in tournaments, playing games such as Marvel vs Capcom 2, Street Fighter III: Third Strike, Capcom vs SNK 2, Street Fighter IV, and Street Fighter V. In 2010, Ortiz placed second in the Evolution Super Street Fighter IV tournament. She also came in second in the 2016 Capcom Cup.

Scarlett

Sasha "Scarlett" Hostyn is indeed a highly recognized Canadian profes-

sional StarCraft II player. She is often referred to as the "Queen of StarCraft" due to her remarkable gameplay and numerous achievements in StarCraft II tournaments. Scarlett began her StarCraft II career in 2011, and over the years, she has competed for multiple esports organizations such as Team Acer, Newbee, Brave Star Gaming, and Shopify Rebellion.

She's known for her aggressive and unpredictable Zerg style, with a unique ability to adapt mid-game, giving her a significant advantage over her opponents. Her notable achievements include winning the 2012 Playhem "Sponsor Me!" Tournament, the 2012 StarCraft II World Championship

Series Canada, the 2012 StarCraft II World Championship Series North America, and the 2018 Intel Extreme Masters PyeongChang.

Scarlett made headlines in 2013 by becoming the first woman to win a StarCraft II premier tournament at the 2013 Red Bull Battle Grounds: New York City. She is also the first non-Korean woman to win a major StarCraft II tournament, which she achieved at the 2018 Intel Extreme Masters in PyeongChang, South Korea. Scarlett is also well known for her 2018 victory over two-time world champion Lee "INnoVation" Shin-hyung in the Global StarCraft II League (GSL) Code S, where she became the first non-Korean woman to advance to the round of 16 in the GSL's history.

Mary

Maryam "Mary" Maher is a 16-year-old professional VALORANT player from Bahrain. She is one of the youngest female esports pros in the world, and she is already making a name for herself on the international stage. Mary first started playing VALORANT in 2020, and joined the G2 Gozen team in 2022. Mary is known for her aggressive playstyle and her ability to clutch in high-pressure situations. She is also a very versatile player, and she can play multiple roles on the team. In 2022, Mary helped G2 Gozen win the VCT Game Changers Championship. This was a major accomplishment, as it was the first time that an all-female team had won a major VALORANT tournament. Mary was named MVP of the tournament, and she was also named to the First Team All-VALORANT.

Mary is an inspiration to many young women who are interested in esports. She is proof that anyone can achieve their dreams, regardless of their age or gender. She is also a role model for young women who are interested in playing VALORANT. Mary shows that women can be just as good as men at VALORANT, and she is an inspiration to all female gamers. *